

The Supplemental Complaint alleges that Defendants intentionally entered Plaintiff's property or caused others to enter without her permission to cut her Ficus trees. (Supp. Compl. ¶¶ 24-25.) She had instructed Defendants they could not enter her property to cut the trees without her being there. (*Id.* ¶ 25.) She alleges that the Association had permission to enter to perform regular landscape maintenance but, its actions in this case exceeded that authority. (*Id.* ¶ 26.) It is alleged her property was damaged by the illegal cutting, trimming, and destruction of her trees for which entry was a substantial factor in causing harm entitling her to damages. (*Id.* ¶¶ 28-29.)

The Association asserts that the maintenance provisions in the CC&Rs authorize it and its agents including Vintage Landscape to enter Plaintiff's property and perform landscaping maintenance. (UMF Nos. 9-26, 121-138.) Plaintiff's letter dated 6/11/21 does not supersede the authorization granted to the Association and its agents (and recorded). (UMF No. 31, 143.) Entry onto the subject property by the Association's management team or Vintage Landscape was lawful as they were agents of the Association. (UMF Nos. 9-26, 34, 121-138, 146.)

Plaintiff's response is the same as to these facts as discussed previously. Plaintiff has not established that the Association trespassed on her property. Thus, Plaintiff has not met her burden. GRANTED.

3rd and 4th Causes of Action - Violation of Civil Code § 3346 and CCP § 733

These statutes provide for treble damages for wrongful injuries to trees or trespass for cutting and carrying away trees or timber.

Here, the Association asserts that the Ficus trees (Hedge) were planted and maintained by the Association through its agent Vintage Landscape. (UMF Nos. 169-177.) Vintage Landscape has an employee who is a certified arborist and ensured the trees were never harmed nor in jeopardy. (UMF No. 178.) Plaintiff did not obtain an arborist opinion. (UMF No. 179.) The trees continue to grow and are thriving. (UMF No. 180.)

Plaintiff does not dispute that the trees were planted by the Association. (PRSS, UMF No. 169.) She only takes issue with the reference to the Ficus trees as a "Hedge". (*Ibid.*) She also asserts that Vintage Landscape entered her property without her permission and against her written instructions. (PRSS, UMF Nos. 172-173, 175-179.) She concludes by asserting that the harm that she seeks recovery for occurred in 2024 and 2025; she does not claim the trees were permanently damaged. (PRSS, UMF No. 180.) Importantly, Plaintiff has not established the alleged injuries to her trees. Thus, Plaintiff has not met her burden. GRANTED.

2.

CASE #	CASE NAME	HEARING NAME
CVPS2500640	LOW VS PGA WEST FAIRWAYS ASSOCIATION, A CA NON-PROFIT MUTUAL BENEFIT COMMON INTEREST DEVELOPMENT CORPORATION	HEARING ON MOTION FOR SUMMARY ADJUDICATION ON 1ST AMENDED COMPLAINT OF PATRICIA LOW BY DEFENDANT CRAIG DETLOFF

Tentative Ruling: Granted.

Summary judgment granted as to moving party, Defendant Craig Detloff, only.

Moving party to provide notice pursuant to CCP 1019.5.

Plaintiff, Patricia Low, alleges she has a residence located at 81160 Kingston Heath in La Quinta, which is within the PGA West Fairways development. Plaintiff alleges that Defendant, PGA West Fairways

Association (Association) and Defendant, Craig Detloff (Detloff), who lives next door to Plaintiff, engaged in a scheme to vandalize/cut her Ficus trees that exist on the common property line between Plaintiff's property and Detloff's property despite her express instruction that her trees were not to be cut. Plaintiff filed this lawsuit on 1/24/25 because of the unlawful and illegal destruction of her property. Thereafter, on 5/12/25 and 10/3/25, the Association caused or directed the landscaper to cut Plaintiff's Ficus trees again without Plaintiff's express permission. On 10/3/25, the landscaper cut a hole in the middle of the Ficus trees at eye level rather than trimming the tops or thinning the edges. Plaintiff also alleges that after filing the action, Detloff has been seen in a tree peering into her yard, which has made her concerned for her safety.

Plaintiff's operative Supplemental Complaint was filed on 5/19/26 alleging five causes of action: 1) breach of governing documents (against the Association only); 2) trespass; 3) violation of Civil Code § 3346; 4) violation of CCP § 733; and, 5) invasion of privacy (against Detloff only).

Defendant, Craig Detloff (Detloff), brings this motion for summary adjudication as to the 2nd, 3rd, and 4th causes of action on the ground that there are no triable issues of material fact as to these claims as against Detloff. (CCP § 437c.) Detloff argues that he was not the cause of Plaintiff's harm and made no intentional, reckless, or negligent entry onto Plaintiff's property. Detloff asserts that he had the legal right to request the Association have portions of branches of Plaintiff's Ficus trees that were overhanging and encroaching onto his property be cut, trimmed, or pruned.

Plaintiff, Patricia Low, opposes the motion arguing that Detloff acted in concert with the Association to unlawfully cut her Ficus trees, which was done at his insistence and direction; that Plaintiff withdrew any consent to enter her property, which the Association had honored for years; that Detloff can be liable for trespass by directing, encouraging and threatening the Association with legal action to enter Plaintiff's property; and, that Detloff was focused on the height of Plaintiff's trees, not on overhanging/encroaching branches until the Association changed the rule about height of hedges.

The Reply asserts that Plaintiff's Opposition focuses on Detloff's communications with the Association but, cites no evidence creating a triable issue of material fact as to Detloff's liability; that Plaintiff has not established aiding and abetting through actual knowledge to participate in tortious activity; that while Plaintiff claims the Association had no authority to enter her property, she also acknowledges that her property is subject to the CC&Rs and that the Association is responsible for landscaping maintenance.

Summary Judgment/Adjudication

From commencement to conclusion, the party moving for summary judgment bears the burden of persuasion. (*Aguilar v. Atlantic Richfield Company* (2001) 25 Cal.4th 826, 855.) A defendant can meet his initial burden by showing that one or more elements of the cause of action cannot be established, or that there is a complete defense. (CCP § 437c(p)(2).) To demonstrate that a cause of action cannot be established, the defendant must either negate an essential element of the plaintiff's cause of action or show that the plaintiff lacks evidence. (*Chavez v. Glock* (2012) 207 Cal.App.4th 1283, 1301.) To negate an element, the defendant must establish that plaintiff's claims fail as a matter of law. (*Eriksson v. Nunnick* (2011) 191 Cal.App.4th 826, 849 (applying rule to issues of duty).) To demonstrate that the plaintiff lacks evidence, the defendant must show that the plaintiff does not possess and cannot reasonably obtain needed evidence. (*Aguilar*, supra, 25 Cal.4th at 855.) A defendant may not simply point to an absence of evidence but must show that the plaintiff cannot reasonably obtain evidence. (*Gaggero v. Yura* (2003) 108 Cal.App.4th 884, 891.)

Once that burden has been met, the burden shifts to the opposing party to produce admissible evidence showing a triable issue of material fact exists. (CCP § 437c(p)(2); *Arcienaga v. Bank of San Bernardino* (1997) 52 Cal.App.4th 213, 231.) Although summary judgment is no longer considered a "disfavored" procedure, the rule continues that the moving party's evidence must be strictly construed, while the opposing party's evidence must be liberally construed. (*Binder v. Aetna Life Ins. Co.* (1999) 75 Cal.App.4th

832.) An opposing party may not rely upon the allegations or denials in its pleadings, but must “set forth the specific facts showing that a triable issue of material fact exists.” (CCP § 437c(p)(2).) Claims and theories not supported by admissible evidence do not raise triable issues of fact. (*Rochlis v. Walt Disney Co.* (1993) 19 Cal.App.4th 201, 219, *disapproved on another ground in Turner v. Anheuser-Busch, Inc.* (1994) 7 Cal.4th 1238.)

A motion for summary judgment may be granted where it is shown that the “action has *no* merit or that there is no defense to the action or proceeding.” (CCP § 437c(a).) A motion for summary adjudication can be granted only if it *completely disposes* of the cause of action, affirmative defense, claim for damages or issue of duty. (CCP § 437c(f)(1).) Although summary judgment/adjudication is no longer considered a “disfavored” procedure, the rule continues that the moving party’s evidence must be strictly construed, while the opposing party’s evidence must be liberally construed. (*Binder v. Aetna Life Ins. Co.* (1999) 75 Cal. App. 4th 832.)

2nd Cause of Action - Trespass

“A trespass is an invasion of the interest in the exclusive possession of land, as by entry upon it.” (*Capogeannis v. Superior Court* (1993) 12 Cal.App.4th 668, 674.) “The elements of trespass are: (1) the plaintiff’s ownership *or control* of the property; (2) the defendant’s intentional, reckless, or negligent entry onto the property; (3) lack of permission for the entry or acts in excess of permission; (4) harm; and (5) the defendant’s conduct was a substantial factor in causing the harm.” (*Ralphs Grocery Co. v. Victory Consultants, Inc.* (2017) 17 Cal.App.5th 245, 261–262.)

The Supplemental Complaint alleges that Defendants intentionally entered Plaintiff’s property or caused others to enter without her permission to cut her Ficus trees. (Supp. Compl. ¶¶ 24-25.) She had instructed Defendants they could not enter her property to cut the trees without her being there. (*Id.* ¶ 25.) She alleges that the Association had permission to enter to perform regular landscape maintenance but, its actions in this case exceeded that authority. (*Id.* ¶ 26.) It is alleged her property was damaged by the illegal cutting, trimming, and destruction of her trees for which entry was a substantial factor in causing harm entitling her to damages. (*Id.* ¶¶ 28-29.)

Detloff asserts that this case is based on alleged improper cutting of Plaintiff’s Ficus trees or hedges. (Undisputed Material Fact [UMF] No. 1.) Detloff is the former owner of real property next door to Plaintiff’s property. (UMF Nos. 2-3.) Detloff never entered Plaintiff’s property to remove, cut, prune, or otherwise trim the Ficus trees on Plaintiff’s property. (UMF Nos. 4-5.) While he lived in his former residence, he asked the Association to remove the portions of the Ficus trees that were overhanging or encroaching onto his property. (UMF No. 6.) Detloff never instructed the Association or Vintage Landscape how to perform the work. (UMF No. 7.) Detloff never hired anyone including Vintage Landscape to trim the Ficus trees. (UMF No. 8.) He never asked anyone to cut into the interior of the trees to create a more open space to look through them. (UMF No. 9.)

In response, Plaintiff asserts that this action involves more than the improper cutting of her Ficus trees; it involves violations of her privacy, safety concerns, selective enforcement, and Detloff acting in concert with the Association. (Plaintiff’s Responsive Separate Statement [PRSS] UMF No. 1.) Plaintiff asserts that Detloff has repeatedly directed, encouraged, coordinated with, and threatened the Association with legal action regarding the Association’s entry onto Plaintiff’s property to remove, cut, prune, or otherwise trim the Ficus trees, which were severely cut to the trunks obviously damaging the trees and were left with several infrastructure holes to allow Detloff to peer into Plaintiff’s yard. (PRSS, UMF Nos. 4-5, 9.) Plaintiff asserts that Detloff did not complain about overhanging branches. (PRSS, UMF No. 6.) He directed the Association’s general manager and the landscapers on where and what to cut from her trees and how the work was to be performed. (UMF No. 7.)

In addition, Plaintiff asserts her own additional facts concerning Detloff's communications with the Association and the landscapers. (PRSS, Plaintiff's Additional Material Facts [PAMF] Nos. 1-25.)

Plaintiff concedes that Detloff did not personally enter her property, but she claims he directed, and encouraged others to enter her property. Plaintiff argues that Detloff is liable for trespass based on an aiding and abetting theory in which he directed and encouraged the Association and Vintage Landscape on the manner and extent of cutting. (PRSS, UMF Nos. 4-7, 9; PAMF Nos. 1-24.) Plaintiff argues that if Detloff was aware that entering her property constitutes an unauthorized entry and he substantially encouraged the Association and/or its agent, Vintage Landscape to enter, Detloff can be civilly liable for the trespass. (*Austin B. v. Escondido Union School Dist.* (2007) 149 Cal.App.4th 860, 879.)

A defendant is liable for aiding and abetting if the person (1) knows the other's conduct constitutes a breach of duty and gives substantial assistance or encouragement to the other to so act or (2) gives substantial assistance to the other in accomplishing a tortious result and the person's own conduct, separately considered, constitutes a breach of duty to the third person. (*Casey v. U.S. Bank National Association* (2005) 127 Cal.App.4th 1138, 1144.)

The problem here is that Plaintiff has not asserted any facts to establish that Detloff *knew* the Association's or Vintage Landscape's conduct constituted a trespass, and that he provided substantial assistance or encouragement to enter Plaintiff's property. She has not asserted any facts to establish that Detloff gave substantial assistance to the Association or Vintage Landscape in accomplishing a tortious result and Detloff's own conduct separately considered, constituted a breach of duty to a third person. Without such facts, Plaintiff cannot establish Detloff's actual knowledge that the Association's or Vintage Landscape's wrongful conduct or his own conduct constituted a trespass. Notably, Detloff points out that Plaintiff inconsistently claims that the Association trespassed on her property while also acknowledging her property is subject to CC&Rs, which authorize it and its agents to enter properties to perform landscaping maintenance. Thus, Plaintiff has not met her burden. The motion is granted in favor of Detloff on this cause of action. GRANTED

3rd and 4th Causes of Action - Violation of Civil Code § 3346 and CCP § 733

These statutes provide for treble damages for wrongful injuries to trees or trespass for cutting and carrying away trees or timber. The statutes require an underlying trespass. However, as discussed above, Plaintiff has not raised a triable issue of material fact as to Detloff trespassing onto her property nor has she established his potential liability based on an aiding and abetting theory. Moreover, Plaintiff has not established the alleged injuries to her trees. Thus, Plaintiff has not met her burden. The motion is granted in favor of Detloff on these causes of action. GRANTED.

3.

CASE #	CASE NAME	HEARING NAME
CVPS2504364	SIMONYAN VS MARRIOTT INTERNATIONAL, INC.	MOTION 1 TO COMPEL KRISTINA GALSTYAN'S FURTHER RESPONSES TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION SET ONE, BY DEFENDANT MARRIO HOTEL SERVICES, LLC

Tentative Ruling: Hearing continued to Tuesday, September 29, 2026 at 8:30 a.m., Department PS2.

No further briefing will be permitted.